

Ahmet Ozan Apaydın

Game Researcher & Narrative Designer

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PROFILE

Narrative Designer and Game Researcher combining 3 years of game industry experience with academic study in interactive media. Specializes in bridging the gap between gameplay systems and cinematic storytelling, currently developing an alternative "Hero's Journey" framework to resolve ludonarrative dissonance. Proven expertise in crafting dystopian sci-fi worlds, branching narratives, and directing transmedia projects that span digital and physical formats.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Narrative Designer

Wendigo Games

04/2022 – 12/2024

İstanbul, Türkiye

- Led the rewriting and restructuring of the story and narrative for ORPHEUS: Tale of a Lover.
- Designed a bureaucratic, humorous world with unique characters, drawing inspiration from Greek mythology and Borderlands.
- Managed the social media accounts of both Wendigo Games and WHAT THE PAK?!
- Created comedic skits and short-formed videos, using the Sequencer in Unreal Engine.
- Worked with voice actors on in-game voiceovers and trailer narration sessions.

Freelance Writer

SenpAI

10/2020 – 09/2021

Remote/Türkiye, Estonia

- Authored blog posts focused on League of Legends, including patch notes, tips, and trivia articles.
- Wrote all user-facing scripts for the SenpAI desktop application, ensuring clarity and engagement.

Web Content Writer

5Mid

01/2020 – 11/2020

Remote/Türkiye

- Worked as a content writer and game journalist, producing articles and news features on esports and gaming.
- Played a key role in transforming Türkiye's first esports news page into a comprehensive game news platform.

ACADEMIC WORKS

Traditional Screenwriting vs. Interactivity: Resolving Ludonarrative Dissonance through an Alternative Hero's Journey

M.A. Thesis

- Investigated the friction between traditional cinematic screenwriting (Vogler's Hero's Journey) and gameplay interactivity by analyzing 10 TGA "Best Narrative" winning titles.
- Developed a custom 4-pillar Analysis Matrix to evaluate ludonarrative dissonance, cross-examining story beats with active ludic mechanics and player psychology.
- Designed "The Gamer's Journey," an alternative, interactivity-first narrative framework to help developers harmonize gameplay systems with established storytelling structures.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teacher's Assistant

Bahçeşehir University

- **Game History and Analyzing:** Supported lectures on the history and systematic analysis of video games, occasionally serving as the substitute lecturer in the professor's absence.
- **Writing for Games:** Assisted in teaching worldbuilding and setting creation. Guided students through practical assignments focused on designing custom domains and antagonists within the *Dungeons & Dragons* Ravenloft framework.
- **Basics of Writing:** Supported instruction on branching narrative structures, utilizing the *D&D* Planescape setting to help students apply interactive storytelling concepts to their coursework.

Guest Speaker

Beykoz University & Doğuş University

- **Storytelling in Video Games:** Delivered targeted presentations to Digital Game Design students on the structural differences between traditional linear scriptwriting and interactive narrative design.

EDUCATION

Game Design M.A.

Bahçeşehir University

Present

Radio, TV and Cinema B.A.

İstanbul University

LANGUAGES

Turkish

English

PROJECTS

ORPHEUS: A Tale of a Lover

Narrative Designer

- Joined mid-development to restructure the narrative and ensure coherence with the game's design.
- Developed a linear story inspired by the myth of Orpheus, incorporating a unique bureaucratic twist.
- Collaborated closely with design and development teams to create and revise **narrative documentation**, ensuring alignment with game pacing and design goals.
- Used **Articy Draft** to create story sketches and pitching ideas.

WHAT THE PAK?!

Social Media Manager/Marketing Associate

- Defined the **brand identity** and overall tone of the project.
- Managed the social media accounts and created SM posts.
- Directed and produced in-engine cinematic trailers, comedic skits, and gameplay showcases using **Unreal Engine Sequencer**

UPLOAD: The Hint

Solo Developer

- Developed a cyberpunk universe inspired by *Isaac Asimov*, focusing on an AI uprising theme.
- Wrote a short thriller scenario with multiple endings for a narrative-driven game.
- Collaborated with freelance artists and guided them while creating visual assets for the project.

UPLOAD: The Doubt

Director

- **Wrote, directed and edited** a short film that takes place in my fictional universe, turning it into a transmedia project.
- Worked with a freelance voice actor and guided her on maintaining the convenient tone of the sounds.

AnoValley

Game Designer/Graphic Designer

- Contributed to a small tabletop project as a graphic designer, refining visuals and building mechanics to enhance gameplay.
- Developed and polished this project as part of a school assignment during my Game Design M.A. program.

ID Universe

Content Creator

- Created and managed a fictional **transmedia** persona on Instagram, acting as a multiverse-traveling photographer.
- Synthesized visual mashups of pop culture media and authored short-form, in-character narrative posts to build an engaged audience.

Problem Solved

Narrative Designer

- Created a bureaucratic dystopia with sci-fi elements. Documented every detail about the universe and narrative.
- Wrote **300 dialogues** and guided **6 different voice actors in 2 different languages**.

UPLOAD: Turing Test

Solo Developer

- Solo-developing a board game inspired by *Betrayal at House on the Hill*, incorporating social deduction mechanics to further expand my fictional universe.

Present

SKILLS

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|------------------|-------------------|-------------------|---------------|
| • Unreal Engine | • Sequencer | • Articy Draft 3 | • Twine |
| • Adobe Premiere | • Adobe Photoshop | • Spreadsheets | • Documenting |
| • Scriptwriting | • Worldbuilding | • Public Speaking | • Lecturing |